

CRP0420 – UNLISTED OR MISCELLANEOUS PROCEDURE CODE REIMBURSEMENT



Benefit Type:	Medicare; Medi-Cal
Category:	Coding & Reimbursement Policy
Effective Date:	5/28/2026
Last Updated:	5/28/2026
Prior Authorization:	Prior Authorization Required May Be Required
Plan Info:	SCAN Plan Documents
Network Coverage:	In Network; Out of Network

OVERVIEW

This policy establishes the standards for claim payment when SCAN Health Plan covers a service under a member's benefit plan. It defines the coding conventions and documentation expectations used to determine whether a submitted claim qualifies for payment and at what amount. Claims must be billed using industry-standard codes such as Current Procedural Terminology (CPT), Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System (HCPCS), and applicable revenue codes, and all billed services must be fully supported by contemporaneous medical records and office documentation. Coverage determinations do not guarantee payment; reimbursement is contingent on compliance with coding, documentation, authorization, and medical-necessity requirements applicable to the procedure, diagnosis, and the member's state of residence.

This policy applies to both participating and non-participating providers and facilities. Coding methodology, reimbursement logic, regulatory requirements, benefits design, and contractual obligations inform policy development and application. The policy may be supplemented, modified, or superseded by provider agreements, state or federal mandates, CMS requirements, the enrollee's benefit documents, or other applicable policies. SCAN Health Plan reserves the right to revise and publish updated policy versions and will endeavor to minimize variations in implementation across electronic claims processing systems.

POLICY/POSITION STATEMENT

In alignment with accepted healthcare coding standards and procedures, SCAN Health Plan only reimburses unlisted or miscellaneous CPT and HCPCS codes when no more specific code accurately describes the service or procedure performed. Claims for unlisted or miscellaneous procedure codes may require clinical review and must include sufficient contemporaneous clinical documentation to establish the exact service or procedure which was performed, confirm medical necessity, and determine coverage under Medicare. When coding, billing, or documentation standards are not met, SCAN Health Plan may reject or deny claims and may recover or recoup payments for unlisted or miscellaneous codes, in accordance with contractual and regulatory provisions.

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Submission and Documentation Requirements

- Providers should submit a claim with an unlisted code **only** when no existing CPT or HCPCS code accurately describes the service provided.
- Unlisted procedure codes submitted with a modifier may be denied; exceptions: DME, orthotics, and prosthetics require the appropriate NU, RR, or MS modifier.
- Unlisted drugs must be submitted with a National Drug Code (NDC).
- Contemporaneous clinical documentation must be provided that supports the service and medical necessity, including a concise narrative explaining the service and why no specific CPT or HCPCS code was applied; an itemized operative or procedure report when applicable; and objective supporting data such as diagnostic tests, imaging, or pathology.
- Documentation of procedure duration, complexity, and any atypical resource use or supplies that affect coding or pricing
- For DME, implants, or supplies, include manufacturer, model, product number, and invoice when applicable.

Beneficiary Notice and Consent for Medicare Members

- When a service billed with an unlisted code may be noncovered, or coverage is uncertain for a Medicare beneficiary, providers must follow Medicare beneficiary notice requirements (for example, obtain an Advance Beneficiary Notice or other required written notice) before providing the service when feasible. For Medi-Cal or other state-regulated beneficiaries, providers must follow applicable state beneficiary notice rules.
- A copy of any beneficiary notice and the beneficiary's signed acknowledgement (or documented attempt to obtain acknowledgement when signature is not feasible) must be included in the claim file.

Provider Responsibilities and Compliance

- Providers are responsible for the accuracy and completeness of all documentation submitted to support unlisted codes.
- Providers must comply with all applicable federal and state laws, CMS and Medi-Cal guidance, and SCAN Health Plan policies when submitting unlisted codes.

REGULATORY CITATIONS/REFERENCES

- [Unlisted Code Billing - JF Part A - Noridian](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [CMS Manual System](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [Unlisted and Not Otherwise Classified Code Billing - JE Part B - Noridian](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [SCAN Provider Operations Manual \(POM\)](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)

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- [CMS Medicare Policy Manual Chapter I General Correct Coding Policies For Medicare National Correct Coding Initiative Policy Manual](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [Medicare Managed Care Manual Chapter 13](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [42 C.F.R. § 422.568 Standard timeframes and notice requirements for organization determinations](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [CMS MLN Complying with Medical Record Documentation Requirements](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [Medicare Claims Processing Manual Chapter 26 - Completing and Processing Form CMS-1500 Data Set](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [American College of Surgeons Unlisted procedures: Strategies for successful reimbursement](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [AAPC Understanding the Updated Guidance for Reporting Unlisted Codes in the CPT 2024 Code Set.pdf](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)
- [Medi-Cal Providers Manual Part 1 — Medi-Cal Program & Eligibility](#) (Accessed 12/19/2025)

DISCLAIMERS

The information provided above is accurate as of the policy review date. However, CMS coverage policies are subject to periodic updates and revisions. As a result, this document may not reflect the most recent changes. For the latest information on applicable National Coverage Determinations (NCDs), Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs), Local Coverage Articles (LCAs), and CMS Online Manual System Transmittals, please visit the Medicare Coverage Database at: <https://www.cms.gov/medicare-coverage-database/search.aspx>.

This Policy is subject to the SCAN Medical Policy Terms of Use and Conditions, available at <https://medicalpolicy.scanhealthplan.com/terms-of-use>.

POLICY GOVERNANCE

Developed by: SCAN Medical Policy

Maintained by: SCAN Medical Policy

Impacted Teams: UM, Embrace, Medical Claims Review, Claims, Grievance and Appeals Department (GAD), Network Management, Medical Policy, Compliance, Member Services

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POLICY HISTORY

Date:	Description:	Control #:
5/28/2026	UMC Approval	1-0420-05282026D
5/28/2026	Effective Date of Policy	1-0420-05282026F

RELATED POLICIES

N/A

RETIRED/SUPERSEDED POLICIES

N/A